

Professorial Contribution, Recognition and Reward

GUIDANCE

Scope

This policy applies to non-clinical professorial staff. Clinical academic professors:

- are not covered by the University pay structure, as their remuneration remains aligned with NHS pay scales. This may include additional NHS payments for excellence in performance.
- will be allocated to a University Professorial Level and may move between the levels in recognition of their contribution to the University

Professorial Levels – Summary Descriptions

There are four Levels of professorial contribution:

Level 1: Professor: Professors who have a strong national and international standing in their discipline and a substantial and sustained track record in research, teaching and enterprise, as per the agreed balance of contribution related to their main domain and, who make a consistently high contribution as leaders. This is the normal entry Level for internally appointed/newly appointed Professors.

Level 2: Accomplished Professor: Professors with a widely recognised international reputation for excellence in their discipline, based on sustained achievements in research, teaching and enterprise, as per the agreed balance of contribution related to their main domain and, who make a consistently high contribution as leaders. This Level will be occupied by those who have progressed from Level 1 or have been appointed from a professorial post at another institution.

Level 3: Highly Accomplished Professor: Professors whose academic distinction is such that they would be acknowledged as an international leader in a significant field of study based on sustained and high-Level achievements in research, teaching, enterprise and practice, as per the agreed balance of contribution related to their main domain and, who make a consistently high contribution as leaders.

Level 4: Eminent Professor: Professors who are preeminent in their field and are acknowledged as one of a group of world leaders who shape thinking in a significant field of study.

Professorial Salaries

Professorial Salaries are illustrated in the table below and effective from **1 August 2025**.

- These ranges apply to all professors at the specified level, irrespective of their subject discipline.
- Salaries at professorial Level 4 are benchmarked against relevant sector surveys, including international benchmarks where appropriate, which informs decisions on individual salaries for professors at this level.

Professorial Level	Spine Point	Min (£)	Max (£)
Level 1 Salary Range	55	80,526	N/A
	56	82,936	N/A
	57	85,416	N/A
	58	87,975	N/A
	59	90,606	N/A
	Off Scale	90,607	99,001
Level 2 Salary Range	Off Scale	99,002	118,208
Level 3 Salary Range	Off Scale	118,209	145,370
Level 4 Salary Range	Off Scale	145,371	Uncapped

Market Supplements

Additional market-related pay will only be applied where there is an objective justification to recruit or retain an individual. This requires clear evidence that:

- The market pays higher salaries for the relevant discipline, and market benchmark data validates the need for the supplement.
- The professor being recruited is already earning that higher salary or has received an offer for a comparable position at a higher salary.
- There is a strategic justification for awarding a market supplement.

Where a market supplement is applied, the base salary continues to determine the professorial level. Market supplements will be monitored and reviewed every two years. Full details are provided in the *Market Supplement Policy*.

Discretionary Pay Awards and Progression

Level 1 Professors

For Professors at Level 1, the salary range begins at spine point 55 on Grade 10.

Professors at level 1, on the pay scale, will typically receive an annual increase to the next salary point **without** the need for a case for progression to be put forward. This is subject to confirmation of satisfactory performance by the Dean of School or PVC and Head of Faculty following a Professional Development Review (PDR).

In view of this, professors at Level 1 who are currently paid on the Grade 10 scale points 55 to 58 will not be eligible to apply for a 1%, 2% or 3% uplift in salary until the top of the incremental scale (spine point 59) is reached. (However, they are still eligible to apply for a non-consolidated payment or a move to the next professorial Level, should they be able to evidence that they meet the criteria for the next level).

Professors at Level 1, currently at the top of the incremental scale (spine point 59) may apply for further pay increases through the annual Non-clinical Professorial Review process. Applications must demonstrate evidence of a sustained, high-level contribution, assessed against the indicators for the relevant Professorial Level.

Professors at Levels, 2, 3 and 4

Professors at these levels are appointed on spot salaries. The specific salary within the range is determined by an individual's track record and performance, and an analysis of comparability within the level.

Further pay increases may be requested through the annual Non-clinical Professorial Review process. Applications must demonstrate evidence of sustained high-level contribution, as assessed against the indicators for the professorial Level.

Exceptional Performance Awards

For exceptional performance over a particular year, all professors are eligible to apply for a non-consolidated payment of £1,500 through the Non-clinical Professorial Review process (Annual Review).

Move to the Next Professorial Level

All professorial staff may apply to progress to the next level by providing evidence that they meet the required criteria. A case for advancement can be submitted through the Non-clinical Professorial Review process, where a professor demonstrates that they satisfy the criteria for the higher level. Further guidance is available in the section titled Professorial Criteria and Descriptors.

Additional Guidance

- The University expects that progression from Level 1 to Level 2 would be a normal expectation in the career of a professor, however, the expected contribution at Levels 3 and 4 is much greater than at Levels 1 and 2 and so numbers progressing to the higher levels are likely to be much less.
- To be eligible to apply, a PDR must have been completed within the 12 months preceding the application.
- All annual salary considerations are informed by market assessments of professorial pay, using benchmark data from the Russell Group and UCEA salary surveys.
- Applications will be reviewed by a panel; please note that this process does not involve an interview.
- The panel's decision is final; there is no appeal process.

Headship Allowance

Professors undertaking fixed-term headship roles will continue to receive their professorial salary and may be eligible for a Headship Allowance of £9,000 per annum per full-time equivalent (FTE).

For part-time headship roles, this allowance is pro-rated.

The allowance is payable for the duration of the appointment and ceases at the end of the appointment.

The table below outlines the standard lengths of tenure for academic management and leadership roles:

ROLE	Length of Tenure (First Term)	Length of Tenure (Second Term)
Associate Pro Vice-Chancellors	5 years	5 years
Dean	5 years	5 years
Head of Department	4 years	4 years

In exceptional circumstances, certain leadership roles may warrant additional remuneration. Any such payment must be approved by the Vice-Chancellor.

The salaries of **Clinical Heads** are not covered by the pay scale as their pay is linked to NHS pay scales.

Criteria and Descriptors

Professorial contribution must be demonstrated through verifiable evidence across multiple domains. Examples include:

- a) **Publications:** High-quality, original research outputs published in leading journals or presses. Evidence of sustained scholarly productivity.
- b) **Citations or/and H-Index:** Indicators of academic influence and recognition within the discipline.
- c) **Knowledge Exchange and Impact:** Evidenced contributions to knowledge exchange activities with measurable external impact on policy, practice, or industry.
- d) **Teaching Contribution:** Scope and level of modules taught, innovations in curriculum design, pedagogy, and assessment, supported by evidence of student feedback informing improvements.
- e) **Teaching Awards:** Recognition for excellence in teaching and learning at institutional, national, or international levels.
- f) **Leadership Responsibilities:** Strategic leadership roles within the University or externally, such as Head of Department, Chair of major committees, or leadership in professional bodies.
- g) **Evidence of Esteem:** Indicators of professional standing, including keynote or plenary invitations, fellowships of major scholarly societies, and leadership roles in international academic organisations.
- h) **Income Generation:** Sustained success in securing research funding, consultancy, or other income streams, including leadership of significant grant portfolios supporting major research teams.
- i) **PhD Supervision:** Record of successful supervision and mentoring of doctoral candidates. Contribution to research training and development.
- j) **Continuing professional development Consultancy:** Delivery of CPD programs and consultancy activities that enhance the University's reputation and impact.
- k) **Research Impact:** Evidence of research outcomes with demonstrable societal, economic, or cultural impact.

The tables below outline the criteria and descriptors for professorial progression, structured into four distinct levels (1–4).

These indicators provide a framework for evaluating contributions across key domains of Research, Teaching, Practice, and Leadership. Each level builds cumulatively on the previous, reflecting increasing scope, influence, and impact.

Professors are expected to demonstrate excellence in one lead domain (such as Research or Teaching) while making significant contributions in others. Leadership should be evident across all domains at a level consistent with the chosen lead domain.

RESEARCH INDICATORS			
Level 1	Level 2 (building on the previous level)	Level 3 (building on the previous levels)	Level 4 (building on the previous levels)
• Consistent and repeated production of high impact outputs, which are at least internationally excellent in quality • Consistent achievement in winning significant grants, at least equal to the Russell Group median for the discipline • Planning and leadership of major research programmes • Consistent and evidenced contribution to knowledge transfer, which has measurable impact externally and influences practice in the School/ Institute or Department • Evidence of repeated innovation leading to the creation of intellectual property • Track record of successful postgraduate supervision • Track record of securing significant research funding over several years, success factors include both financial scale and the individual's leadership in the grant portfolio	• Sustained track record of high impact outputs, which are internationally excellent and world-leading in quality • Sustained track record of winning major grants, at least equal to the Russell Group upper quartile for the discipline • Leadership of research programmes which are of major importance for the institution and the discipline • Consistent and leading contribution to shaping knowledge transfer policy in the institution and to innovative and impactful practice • Indications of esteem, such as being on the editorial board of journals, invitations to speak at high profile international conferences, membership of • REF panel, adviser to government bodies and agencies • Sustained track record of securing significant research funding over several years, success factors include both financial scale (on par with the Russell Group median for the discipline) and the individual's leadership in the grant portfolio	• Significant and sustained track record of high impact outputs, which are world-leading in quality • Longstanding and sustained track record of winning major grants, at least equal to the Russell Group upper decile for the discipline • Leadership of research programmes which are internationally leading for the discipline • Significant and sustained track record of innovation leading to high value patents and/or spin outs • Significant impact on government policy for research or for the subject discipline through advisory or committee roles • Indications of high esteem, such as editorship of the highest impact journals for the discipline, invitations to deliver named lecture series or be keynote speaker, award of major prizes from national bodies, REF panel chair, chairing national/international research committees	• An outstanding body of world-leading outputs which have become an essential point of reference for the discipline • Leading research of global significance • Elected to fellowship of esteemed learned societies (e.g. British Academy, Royal Society or international equivalents) • Award of major international prizes • Leading a substantial grant portfolio that supports a major research team within the discipline across the Russell Group / at an international level •

TEACHING INDICATORS			
Level 1	Level 2 (building on the previous level)	Level 3 (building on the previous levels)	Level 4 (building on the previous levels)
• A track record of successful and innovative practice in the design and delivery of teaching and learning • Evidence of impact on teaching in the discipline through peer reviewed outputs • Sustained income from projects or funded developments in teaching and learning • Coaching and development of others to deliver high quality, impactful and innovative disciplinary teaching and/or national/ international teaching. • Consistent and leading contribution to shaping teaching policy and practice in the school or department • Strong, sustained record of enhancing curriculum and course design to advance the University's teaching and learning mission, evidenced by innovations in pedagogy, development of new materials, and use of student feedback to improve teaching and assessment • Leading and influencing assessment policies and/or practices that impact on external governance • Leading Faculty, Institutional or External assessment and feedback strategy and practice • Leading role in influencing policies around the student voice and student representation institutionally and externally	• Evidence of impact on teaching standards and practices beyond own discipline • Authorship of standard textbooks for the discipline and/or sustained track record of research-based outputs which are internationally excellent and world-leading in quality • Sustained and substantial Level of income for projects or funded developments in teaching and learning • Consistent and leading contribution to shaping teaching policy and practice in the institution • Indications of recognition in the profession, e.g. winning teaching awards from national bodies, being on the editorial board of journals, invitations to speak at high profile conferences • Major role in national and/or international educational agencies with responsibilities for higher education policy and curriculum development. • Significant leadership role in national or international educational bodies responsible for higher education policy and curriculum development • Membership of education or training committees of professional institutions • Evidence of driving positive change in teaching practices within the discipline at a national level	• A contribution at this Level would have to be underpinned by research: a significant and sustained track record of high impact outputs, which are world-leading in quality • Significant impact and track record on government policy for teaching and/or for the subject discipline, through advisory or committee roles, inquiries etc. • Sustained high-level of income for projects or developments in teaching and learning • Evidence of extensive advice to international and/or non-governmental bodies on educational matters, which shapes their strategies and policies • Indications of high esteem, such as editorship of the highest impact journals, invitations to deliver named lecture series or be keynote speaker, chairing national/international committees • Proven record of influencing government education policy and contributing to the sector through roles in major advisory bodies, committees, and inquiries • Track record of contributing to major governmental education advisory bodies or agencies with responsibility for the entire education sector	• An outstanding body of world-leading outputs which have become an essential point of reference for the discipline • Leading research of global significance • Elected to fellowship of esteemed learned societies (e.g. British Academy, Royal Society or international equivalents) • Award of major international prizes • Evidence of driving positive change in teaching practices within the discipline at an international level • Track record of leadership of the development of educational policy at international levels

PRACTICE INDICATORS			
Level 1	Level 2 (building on the previous level)	Level 3 (building on the previous levels)	Level 4 (building on the previous levels)
• Evidence of consistent innovation in personal professional casework or creative outputs • Evidence of impact on a profession through publication and/or membership of committees and networks • A track record of income generation from consultancy and/or contracts for services to business • Evidence of repeated impact on business and the community through publication and advice • Coaching and development of others engaged in the field of professional practice • Consistent and leading contribution to shaping the field of professional practice in the school or department • Sustained record of securing research grants, either individually or as part of a team, consistent with expectations in the discipline • Track record of invited talks at international conferences and/or UK HEIs	• Evidence of sustained impact on the development of a professional field nationally through influential personal casework or creative outputs, followed by dissemination • Publication of influential books or articles on the professional field, and/or sustained track record of research-based outputs which are internationally excellent and world-leading in quality • Sustained track record of major income generation through consultancy, services or the creation of intellectual property • Demonstrated impact on the improvement of businesses and the community through high-level advice and major projects • Consistent and leading contribution to shaping the field of professional practice beyond the school or department • Indications of recognition, e.g. appointment as adviser to or committee member of a major professional body, being on the editorial board of journals, invitations to speak at high profile conference and/or to exhibit or perform at high profile festivals, events or venues • Membership on education or training committees of professional societies or public bodies, and service on editorial boards of leading journals or book series	• Evidence of sustained impact on the development of a professional field internationally through formative personal casework or creative outputs, followed by dissemination • Significant and sustained track record of redefining a professional field or of transforming businesses or communities through advice, world-leading research and project activity • Award of major national prizes • Evidence of shaping national policy for a profession, through advisory or committee roles • Indications of high esteem, such as editorship of the highest impact journals, invitations to deliver named lecture series or be keynote speaker and/or to exhibit or perform world-leading festivals, events or venues, chairing national/international committees on a profession and its standards • Elected to Fellowship of a major society	• An outstanding body of world-leading practice, research and scholarly outputs which have become an essential point of reference globally • Making a leading and sustained contribution to shaping the policies and work of major international bodies, or to the development of a profession internationally • Award of major international prizes • Presidency of major scholarly society with significant international profile. • Evidence of shaping international policy for a profession, through advisory or committee roles • Fellowship of the major national Academy e.g., British Academy, Royal Society, or equivalent international academy

LEADERSHIP INDICATORS			
Level 1	Level 2 (building on the previous level)	Level 3 (building on the previous levels)	Level 4 (building on the previous levels)
- Track record of leadership in the academic discipline, within and beyond the institution - Track record of formal and informal leadership and management roles in the school or department - Examples: Contribution to Athena Swan or EDI committees / advancing diversity and inclusivity for students. - Lead initiatives at school, department or faculty Level - Membership of appointment or advisory committees at other institutions - Supporting junior colleagues to develop, through coaching and mentoring and by example - Sustained PGR supervision acting as internal examiner/independent chair and external examiner. - Evidence of shaping research and innovation agendas through advisory roles or active engagement with professional, governmental, industrial bodies, and user communities - Substantive leadership role in enhancing the student experience, in the Faculty, Institution or externally. - Contributions to REF leadership at school/Institute level / output assessment group	- Contribute through formal roles to the running and improvement of the school, department or faculty e.g. sustained success in the implementation of long-term strategic developments with significant internal/external impact - Appointment as external assessor for professorial positions in other institutions - Lead institutional initiatives and/or policy development - Track record of serving as a member or external advisor on appointment, assessment, or advisory committees across other HEIs, non-academic bodies, companies, governments, public sector organizations, and cultural institutions - Leadership of a major cross-University initiative in research, teaching, impact, innovation, entrepreneurship and/or growth of international partnerships	- Proven track record of contributing through formal roles to the effective operation and continuous improvement of the institution - Lead institutional initiatives, policy development and/or the development of major national or international partnerships - Member of a UKRI policy team (or equivalent, including major trusts and foundations) - Sustained track record of holding significant roles in regulatory, advisory, or professional bodies connected to practitioners and service providers across relevant sectors - Leadership of the development of policy at national level. - Leading the growth of PGR numbers, e.g. through externally funded places bringing benefits to multiple academics within subject specialism - REF panellist and/or equivalent major public service to research	- Leadership of major international initiatives, projects or developments on behalf of UK higher education, by appointment of UK or international education bodies or governments - E.g. Member of a UKRI Council (or equivalent) - Key advisor to international non-academic agencies or communities, including companies, governments, public sector bodies, and cultural organisations - Leadership of the development of policy at international levels. - Consistent leadership of national transformational change to the PGR community - REF panel chair and/or equivalent major public service to research